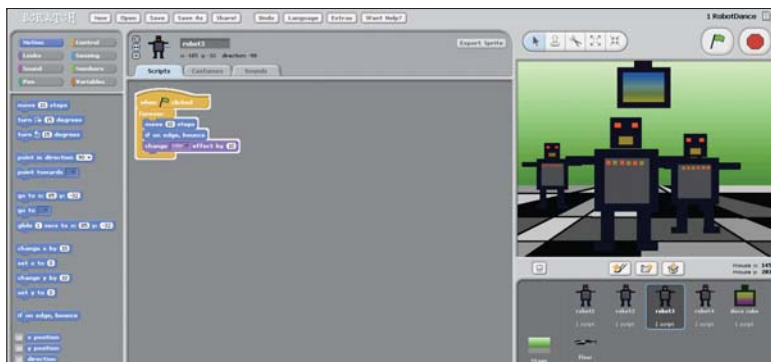




MIT's Scratch teaches children programming the only way they'll learn—with lots of visual elements

console programs—the scripts you create apply to animations. You can create games, presentations, and even what they like to call “interactive art.”

Check out the Web site to see what Scratch is capable of, and sit down with your child and create your next masterpiece together—you can even share it on the site!

Sid Meier's Railroads!

www.2kgames.com/railroads/railroads.html



Let *Railroads!* teach your child the basics of squishing the opposition—through smart resource management, of course

Every child needs a break from all that learning, and Sid Meier's Railroads! is the way to do it. Miniature train sets are nothing short of captivating, and this game will let your child do it in the style of the original rail barons of long ago. The challenge is to set up a rail network in the map you play (parts of North America and Europe, mostly), manage your finances, make profits, buy and sell companies, and get rich before your opponents do. You get to play as and against some of rail history's biggest names, and the game features a veritable encyclopaedia of information on each railway engine and the history of the first railways in general. For a full review of Railroads!, pick up our January 2007 issue.

We're honestly not sure what the lesson is here—maybe your teen (the game isn't for the too-young) will learn the basics of managing incomes, expenditures and loans; perhaps they'll learn the basics of the stock market... you never know. What we do know, however, that *Railroads!* is one of those few games that gives the mind a good, solid workout, and that's always good. ☒

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